Then, he shut down the laptop and took out a sleek notebook from the cupboard along with a grey leather bag containing documents. He then took out a web camera and as he attached it to the laptop, Parminder walked in with another glass of whisky to replace the empty one. She walked out quietly as Singh started placing top-secret documents on the table to take pictures. These included a report on the insurgency in India's north east and an analysis on Sri Lanka by the National Security Council (NSC). He stored the images in the hard drive, then opened a secure file transfer protocol and signed in as 'Spring Flowers.' The transfer began and Rabinder let out a sigh of relief. The entire process took twenty minutes. Then, he switched on the shredder and thrust all the documents into it. He was pleased.

For years, R&AW joint secretary Rabinder Singh had been working as a double agent for the Central Intelligence Agency (CIA), consciously trading his country's secrets. R&AW sources who knew Rabinder Singh and even interacted with him socially, believe that he was recruited by the CIA while working as a counsellor in The Hague in the late 1990s. His desk at the Indian embassy was his cover as a R&AW officer serving abroad. Soft spoken and suave, Singh had served in the army before joining the spy agency in 1987. His handler was Annie, perhaps a codename for a CIA officer in Langley, Virginia.

Recruiting a spy to work as a double agent is the finest art in espionage. It requires a combination of tools ranging from persuasion to pressure. On that Christmas day in 2003, when Singh passed on valuable intelligence to Annie, he was not aware that he had been under the surveillance of the Counter Intelligence and Security unit of the R&AW since July. He never realised that the bearded, middle-aged fruit vendor selling fruit